

crore on the moon mission is nothing but an unnecessary expense and a drain on the exchequer.

V. MOHAN MUSALAY, *Bangalore*

Caste Cauldron

The unrest in Kandhamal is the outcome of long-standing tribal rivalry between the majority Kondhs and the minority Panas, further accentuated by conversions and socio-economic imbalances ("Rider on the Storm", October 27). The state Government, instead of quibbling over the issue and politicising it for electoral gains, should set its house in order and to begin with, improve the standards of governance. The root cause of all the problems is bad governance. If the Government is efficient and prompt in delivering what it promises, things would certainly be different and much better for we, the people.

B.K. NAUTYAL, *Dehradun*

Ballot Battle

For the NDA, the forthcoming Assembly elections in five states are the mini general elections ("Political Matrimonials", October 27). The leaders need to do basic groundwork before joining hands with regional parties like ALADMK, TDP, TRS and RLD since they can make or mar NDAS fate in the ballot battle. The safest bet, however, would be to keep the existing constituents in its fold than to befriend unknown parties.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

Obama Alarm

Democrat Barack Obama has been able to woo NRIs with his pro-India stance but all that he said with reference to Kashmir recently is surely a cause of concern. Obama said that once elected, he would encourage India to solve the Kashmir dispute with Pakistan, so that Islamabad can better cooperate with the US on Afghanistan. Well, India never sought US intervention in this matter.

focusing on larger issues gripping the country, he is embroiled in resolving the blame game arising due to warring ministers, who are concerned about nothing else but their image.

R.S. CHAUBEY, *Varanasi*

Correction

In the article on Viswanathan Anand's world championship victory ("The Bonn Supremacy", November 10), we erroneously mentioned

SUVASISH MULLICK



“Our Indian society seems to have become liberalised. Or why else would we seek legality for live-in relationships? What does this hold for sanctity of the institution called marriage?”

ARUN LAL, *Mumbai*

Their activism is totally uncalled for. If this is what Obama has to offer us in return for our support, we need to watch our step.

V.K. TANGRI, *on e-mail*

Managing Men

Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's plight is understandable ("War Cabinet", November 3). Instead of

that "if Blitz (every player is given 25 minutes to complete a game) is like 50-overs cricket, Rapid is the T-20 version of chess where every player has only five minutes to finish a game." In fact, Rapid is the 25-minute-per-player format and Blitz is the five-minute-per-player version. We regret the error.

30
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At Sanjay's Court

Sanjay Gandhi, errant son of Indira Gandhi, has a remarkable talent for conjuring up militant support at the drop of a sterilisation scalpel. He also displays a remarkable allergy to law courts. Last fortnight, Sanjay stage-managed yet another of his frequent confrontations with the law in the court of Lucknow's Additional Judicial Magistrate, B.D. Kesri, where he was due to appear in connection with the liquor dealer's case. He arrived along with the inevitable rabble of Youth Congress musclemen. Acting on the court's orders, police sealed off the stairway. To add insult to injury, Sanjay sent in an application to the court stating that he "was not being allowed passage by the police". Overlooking his defiance, the magistrate merely asked him to furnish two sureties. Apparently, Sanjay has lost none of his talent for games politicians play.



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